

The Ultimate New Pet Owner Checklist



Preparing Your Home

- ☐ Designate a quiet area for your pet's bed/crate
- ☐ Remove toxic plants (lilies, sago palms, etc.)
- ☐ Secure loose wires and electrical cords
- ☐ Install baby gates if needed
- ☐ Remove small objects that could be choking hazards
- ☐ Store chemicals and medications out of reach
- ☐ Check for gaps in fencing (outdoor areas)
- ☐ Remove fragile items from low shelves/tables
- ☐ Consider carpet runners for slippery floors



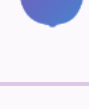
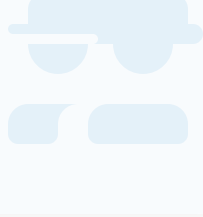
Essential Supplies

For Dogs:

- ☐ Food appropriate for age/size
- ☐ Sturdy food and water bowls
- ☐ Collar with ID tag
- ☐ Leash (standard and training)
- ☐ Harness (if needed)
- ☐ Crate or bed
- ☐ Toys (variety of textures)
- ☐ Treats for training
- ☐ Waste bags
- ☐ Enzymatic cleaner for accidents

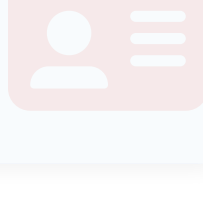
For Cats:

- ☐ Age-appropriate food
- ☐ Food and water bowls
- ☐ Litter box and scoop
- ☐ Cat litter
- ☐ Collar with ID tag
- ☐ Carrier
- ☐ Scratching post
- ☐ Toys (interactive and solo play)
- ☐ Cat bed
- ☐ Treats



First Vet Visit Checklist

- ☐ Schedule visit within first week
- ☐ Bring any existing medical records
- ☐ Note any concerns or unusual behaviors
- ☐ Questions to ask about vaccination schedule
- ☐ Questions to ask about parasite prevention
- ☐ Questions to ask about spay/neuter timing
- ☐ Questions to ask about microchipping
- ☐ Questions to ask about dietary recommendations
- ☐ Questions to ask about exercise guidelines
- ☐ Set up follow-up appointment



Grooming & Hygiene Starter Kit

For Dogs:

- ☐ Pet-safe shampoo
- ☐ Brush appropriate for coat type
- ☐ Nail clippers or grinder
- ☐ Ear cleaning solution
- ☐ Toothbrush and pet toothpaste
- ☐ Styptic powder (for nail bleeding)

For Cats:

- ☐ Cat-specific brush or comb
- ☐ Cat-safe shampoo (if needed)
- ☐ Nail trimmers
- ☐ Toothbrush and cat toothpaste
- ☐ Ear cleaning solution



First Week To-Do Timeline



Day 1: Welcome Home

- ☐ Set up quiet space with bed/crate
- ☐ Introduce water and small amount of food
- ☐ Keep interactions calm and gentle
- ☐ Start establishing bathroom routine

Day 2-3: Settling In

- ☐ Begin basic training (sit, stay)
- ☐ Slowly introduce to different rooms
- ☐ Start regular feeding schedule
- ☐ Monitor water intake and bathroom habits

Day 4-5: Expanding Boundaries

- ☐ Introduce to family members one at a time
- ☐ Begin short play sessions with toys
- ☐ Start leash training (for dogs)
- ☐ Introduce grooming tools gently

Day 6-7: Establishing Routine

- ☐ Firm up feeding and bathroom schedule
- ☐ Begin socializing with other pets (if applicable)
- ☐ Take first short trip outside (for dogs)
- ☐ Evaluate progress and adjust as needed



Emergency & Important Contacts

Primary Vet:	Name, Phone, Address
24-Hour Emergency Vet:	Name, Phone, Address
Poison Control:	Phone Number
Pet Sitter:	Name, Phone
Groomer:	Name, Phone
Training Facility:	Name, Phone
Microchip Company:	Company, Phone, ID #
Pet Insurance:	Company, Policy #, Phone

Pro Tip: Keep this information in your phone and posted somewhere visible in your home. In an emergency, you won't want to waste time searching for contact information.



Additional Notes

Use this space for any additional notes about your pet's preferences, special needs, or reminders...

Remember: Every pet is unique! This checklist is a general guide, but be prepared to adjust based on your pet's individual personality and needs. The most important things you can give your new companion are patience, love, and consistency.

Congratulations on your new family member! 🎉 Wishing you many happy years together.